



Notification Waiver Determination

Regional Australia Bank – South West Slopes Credit Union

Acquisition	Regional Australia Bank Ltd (Regional Australia Bank) applied for a notification waiver in respect of its proposal for South West Slopes Credit Union Ltd (trading as SWSbank) to undertake a Total Transfer of Business of all assets and liabilities to Regional Australia Bank, as described in the transaction documents provided as part of the application (the Acquisition). Upon completion of the Transfer of Business, SWSbank members and customers will be migrated to Regional Australia Bank. All of the assets, liabilities and members of SWSbank will transfer to Regional Australia Bank.
Determination	The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission has determined under section 51ABV(1)(a) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) that the Acquisition is not required to be notified.
Date of determination	10 June 2026

Parties to the Acquisition	The acquirer, Regional Australia Bank, is a customer owned banking institution and has been providing a full range of banking services to its members across regional Australia for over 55 years. Operating in regional NSW, and with administrative offices located across Armidale, Port Macquarie and Lismore, Regional Australia Bank has over 120,000 members, assets of \$5.03 billion and is serviced by 49 branches and offices throughout New South Wales and southern Queensland and around 480 employees. The target, SWSbank, is a customer owned banking institution and has been providing a full range of banking services to its members across the Riverina regions of NSW since its inception in 1972. SWSbank operates 4 branches and 1 agency across its regions with the head office located in Young (NSW). SWSbank employs around 40 staff and has over 14,000 members and \$323 million in assets. Regional Australia Bank and SWSbank provide retail loan and deposit banking services, including, personal, home and business loans, transaction accounts, savings accounts and term deposits to members and customers across regional Australia.
Explanation for determination	In making this notification waiver determination, the Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (the ACCC) has considered the information provided with the notification waiver application and certain publicly available information, and had regard to the factors in section 51ABV(2)(b) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) (the Act).

	Based on the information currently before it, the ACCC considers that the Acquisition is unlikely to give rise to any material lessening of competition. In particular: a. the parties' combined share in the supply of retail lending and retail deposit products in NSW and nationally is low, and the increase in share of supply arising from the Acquisition would be small b. there are alternative suppliers of retail lending and retail deposit products in NSW and nationally. In these circumstances, the ACCC does not consider it necessary to reach a concluded view on the likelihood of the notification thresholds being met. Given that material competition concerns are unlikely to arise, the ACCC has determined that the Acquisition is not required to be notified. The ACCC considers that the determination is consistent with the object of the Act and the interests of consumers in promoting competition. For more information about the ACCC's approach to considering notification waiver applications and to assessing competition effects more generally, see the ACCC's interim guidance on notification waivers and merger assessment guidelines.
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Determination made by Commissioner Williams pursuant to a delegation under section 25(1) of the Act